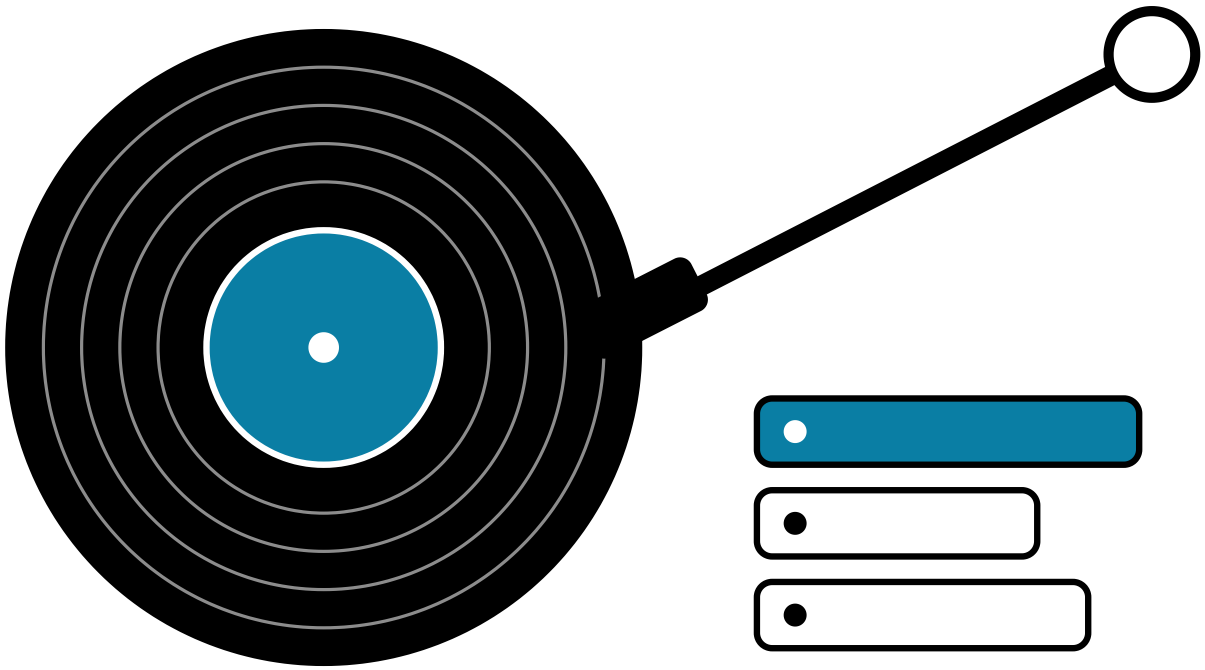
HUDSON BEAT



# TRY A GENRE YOU DON'T KNOW
# GENRE EXPLORATION

DMP2 · research · reference tracks · intro slides

**GRADES 9–12 · 7 CLASS PERIODS · 23 PAGES + 19-SLIDE DECK**

# GENRE EXPLORATION

How to use this resource

START HERE

Teacher

## WHAT THIS IS ·

A 7-class-period structured project for high school music technology. Each student picks a genre they do not already make, researches what defines it, studies 2–3 reference tracks, sketches a loop, composes a full track in that genre, mixes it to fit, reflects, and presents it with Padlet questions for feedback. It is the project from my Digital Music Production 2 course (type: structured; focus: research and style), and the projects in that course can be taught in any order.

## QUICK START ·

1. Read the pacing guide (page 5) and my teacher notes (pages 6–7).
2. Set up your Genre Research Google Form, the Presentation Padlet and the submission spot (page 4).
3. Print the student pages (pages 12–22), one set per student.
4. Open the intro deck and read the speaker notes for Class 1.

## THE INTRO DECK ·

Every slide has a class: Class 1 (slides 1–7), Class 2 (slides 8–10), Class 3 (slides 11–12), Class 4 (slides 13–14), Class 6 (slides 15–17) and Class 7 (slides 18–19). Class 5 is a working day with no new slide. Every slide has speaker notes.

Fonts: the deck uses Oswald and Source Sans 3 (free on Google Fonts, built into Google Slides). If PowerPoint or Keynote shows a different font, install the two fonts or present the PDF copy, which shows the intended look.

## WHAT'S INSIDE ·

| PART | PAGES | USE |
|---|---|---|
| **Teacher pages** | pages 2–11 | How to use, overview, setup, pacing, teacher notes, what changed, Logic quick reference, genre shortlist, worked example |
| **Student pages** | pages 12–22 | Genre research sheet, Reference track log, Loop and form sketch, Work plan, project sheet (3 pages), rubric, vocabulary, feedback planner, reflection prompts |
| **Intro deck (separate file)** | deck | 19 slides, .pptx + PDF, speaker notes on every slide |

### NO AUDIO INCLUDED

No audio, video, songs, artists or genres are named or included. Students choose their own genre and their own reference tracks, and make every sound in their projects themselves. For the Class 1 hook, you only ask questions aloud.

## MAKE IT FIT YOUR CLASS ·

- **Easier or harder:** my variations on page 6: a curated list of 5–8 genres (a blank for it is on page 10), or 2+ minutes with a full arrangement and 2 genre-specific mixing techniques.
- **Feedback board:** my sheets use Padlet for the three questions; any class board works.
- **Any genre:** the pages never name one, so students and you fill in your own.
- **Grading:** my rubric, /25, the average of the student's and your score (page 19).

### IN ONE SENTENCE

Students study a genre they do not know until they can make a track that sounds like it, and then say what they learned.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Project overview

**OVERVIEW**

DMP2 · Structured

**FROM MY DMP2 PROJECT MENU**

**Genre Exploration** · Structured · Research & Style

Step outside your comfort zone and produce a track in an unfamiliar genre. Research, compose, and reflect.

## WHAT STUDENTS MAKE ·

One finished track in a genre the student does not already make, following the genre's typical song form and conventions, with instruments, synths or samples that belong to it and genre-appropriate mixing and production. They complete the Genre Research Google Form first, and hand in a bounced .mp3 or .wav, the zipped .logicx project and a written reflection (one paragraph minimum), plus a Padlet post with three feedback questions, then present.

## WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

Builds analytical listening, research skills, and genre awareness. Forces students out of their default sound palette.

## STANDARDS ·

Supports the National Core Arts Standards for Music (Music Technology, high school): generating and developing ideas (MU:Cr1.1, MU:Cr2.1), presenting work (MU:Pr6.1) and responding to it (MU:Re7.2).

## GOALS ·

- Research and identify the defining characteristics of an unfamiliar genre
- Compose a track that authentically reflects the genre's conventions
- Apply genre-appropriate instrumentation, production techniques, and mixing
- Reflect on the creative process and what you learned

## AT A GLANCE ·

| | |
|---|---|
| **Grades** | 9–12: the second-year course, after a first year of Logic Pro basics |
| **Length** | 7 class periods: research, sketch, three working days, mix and bounce, present |
| **Software** | Logic Pro: instruments, arrangement, mixing, bounce |
| **You supply** | Macs with Logic Pro, headphones, the Genre Research Google Form, a way to stream reference tracks, a feedback board and a place to submit files |
| **Assessment** | My rubric, 5 categories scored 1–5, /25; final grade = average of the student's and the teacher's score (page 19) |

**BEFORE THEY START**

Students should already know how to open a project, add and play instruments, build a loop, and save, bounce and zip in Logic. Nothing new is taught: the quick reference (page 9) shows where each tool lives.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Setup and what to watch

**SETUP**

Teacher

## YOU NEED ·

- **A Mac with Logic Pro** for each student, and **headphones**. Speakers help for the final listen.
- **The Genre Research Google Form.** It is your own form: share the link on your class page. It is not included.
- **A way to stream reference tracks** on student devices (my resource names Spotify, YouTube and Apple Music). The kit includes no track or link.
- **A place to submit** the bounce, the zipped .logicx and the written reflection (your class page).
- **The Presentation Padlet**, set up before Class 1 (yours to set up; none is included).
- **Printed student pages**, one set each (pages 12–22).

## BEFORE CLASS 1 ·

- [ ] Share the Genre Research Google Form on your class page.
- [ ] Set up the Presentation Padlet and, if you like, a shared class playlist (my resource).
- [ ] Decide how students choose: free choice, or a short list from page 10 (my Easier variation).
- [ ] Check that a student computer opens Logic and plays back through headphones.

## WHAT TO WATCH (MY CLOSING NOTE) ·

Students often surprise themselves by enjoying genres they thought they'd hate. Check in with students who expected to dislike their genre.

### KIT SUGGESTIONS, NOT PART OF MY SHEETS

- Approve each genre on Class 1. If it is close to what the student already makes, ask what they would not normally reach for.
- While students work, ask: is that the instrument, or the production style? Which reference sounds most like yours?
- The Work plan (page 15) shows time management in the students' own words.

## MUSIC THEY DID NOT MAKE ·

### A KIT SUGGESTION

Reference tracks are for studying and comparing. Tell students to keep each reference on its own muted track in Logic, delete it before they bounce, and hand in only their own track. No one else's audio goes into the project they submit.

### KEEP THE VOLUME MODERATE

Tell students to start with the headphones low and to check the final mix at a normal level.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Pacing guide · 7 class periods

**PACING**

Teacher

7 class periods, as on my project menu. The “My plan” column is my day-by-day pacing guide as I wrote it; the other columns show what to put on the screen and in students’ hands.

| CLASS | MY PLAN | TEACHER MOVES | DECK | STUDENT PAGES |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **CLASS 1** | **Class 1:** Introduction. Select genre and begin Google Form research. | Slides 1–7: hook, what the project is, the five steps, four words to know, steps 1 and 2. Hand out the project sheet and the Genre research sheet. Approve each student’s genre before they leave. | Slides 1–7 | p. 12, p. 16, p. 17, p. 18, p. 20 |
| **CLASS 2** | **Class 2:** Finish research. Begin sketching an 8–16 bar loop. | Slides 8–10: a genre’s fingerprint, instruments are not enough, before you compose. Hand out the Reference track log and the Loop and form sketch. Check each research sheet for concrete elements. | Slides 8–10 | p. 13, p. 14 |
| **CLASS 3** | **Classes 3–5:** Working days — expand composition, refine arrangement and mix. | Slides 11–12: steps 3 and 4, and the worked example on paper. Hand out the Work plan. Then work time. | Slides 11–12 | p. 15 |
| **CLASS 4** | | Slides 13–14: use your references constantly, and mix like the genre. Then work time. | Slides 13–14 | p. 15 |
| **CLASS 5** | | Full working day: expand, refine, mix. Ask each student to play a reference and then their own track, and say what is different. | No new slides | — |
| **CLASS 6** | **Class 6:** Final mix, bounce, write reflection. Prepare presentations. | Slides 15–17: mix, reflect and bounce, what to turn in, the rubric. Students write the reflection paragraph (page 22) and post their three Padlet questions. | Slides 15–17 | p. 22, p. 19, p. 21 |
| **CLASS 7** | **Class 7:** Presentations with Padlet Q&A peer feedback. | Slides 18–19: presentation day and the close. Every student presents and answers 2 of each classmate’s questions. | Slides 18–19 | p. 21 |

### THE ONE RULE FOR CLASS 1

Approve every genre before the student leaves. If it is close to what they already make (my first struggle), ask: what would you not normally reach for?

### CLASSES 3–5

Working days; Class 5 has no new slide. Circulate with one question: is that the instrument, or the production style?

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# GENRE EXPLORATION



## WHAT THIS PROJECT REINFORCES ·

Builds analytical listening, research skills, and genre awareness. Forces students out of their default sound palette.

## COMMON STUDENT STRUGGLES ·

- Students pick genres too close to what they already make.
- Shallow research — require specific reference tracks and concrete elements.
- Students nail the instruments but miss the production style.
- Reflections are thin. Give specific prompts.

## SUGGESTED VARIATIONS ·

**Easier:** Provide a curated list of 5–8 genres with starter reference tracks and cheat sheets.

**More Advanced:** Require 2+ minutes with a full arrangement. Add a requirement for 2 genre-specific mixing techniques.

### WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH EACH STRUGGLE

- Genres too close to home: the genre check on the Genre research sheet (page 12) and your approval on Class 1.
- Shallow research: the Reference track log (page 13) asks for tempo, form in bars, instruments and production.
- Instruments right, production wrong: slides 8 and 9, and the Work plan's mix-technique lines (page 15).
- Thin reflections: the Reflection prompts (page 22), with a thin and a useful example.

### WHERE THIS KIT HELPS WITH THE VARIATIONS (KIT SUGGESTION)

- Easier: a blank Genre shortlist for your 5–8 genres, starter tracks and cheat sheets (page 10).
- More advanced: the worked example runs 2:36 in sections (page 11), and the Work plan has two lines for the mixing techniques.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Teacher notes · resources, grading, notes

TEACHER NOTES



## SUGGESTED RESOURCES ·

| MY LIST | IN THIS KIT |
|---|---|
| Genre Research Google Form (link on your class page) | Kept as your own form: it is yours to share, and it is not included, because the Drive connector this kit was built with cannot read a Form's questions. The kit adds a paper Genre research sheet beside it (page 12) as a planning copy for the same job: the characteristics of the genre. Requirement 2 stays: students still complete your form. |
| Encourage Spotify, YouTube, or Apple Music for reference tracks | Kept as I wrote it. No track, link or playlist is included, so every reference track is one the student chooses. The Reference track log (page 13) is where students write what they hear. |
| Consider a shared class playlist of genre examples | Kept. The playlist is yours to make: nothing is included. The Genre shortlist (page 10) gives you a place to write the genres and starter tracks you pick. |

## HOW TO GRADE ·

- My rubric: five categories, each scored 1–5, /25 (page 19). Students score themselves first; the final grade is the average of their score and yours.

*Suggestions from this kit, not part of my rubric:*

- Creativity & Originality: ask what the student changed from the genre's usual sound, then listen for it. Copying the genre well is the assignment; adding something of their own is what lifts the score.
- Technical Skill: open the project. Which Logic tools did they use to get the genre's sounds and its production style?
- Composition & Structure: compare the form with the Loop and form sketch (page 14) and with the typical song forms in the Reference track log (page 13).
- Sound Design & Mix Quality: put a reference track next to theirs, as my second tip says, and ask where the mix differs. Instruments right but production wrong is my third struggle.
- Documentation & Presentation: the research sheet, the reference log, the reflection paragraph (page 22) and the Padlet questions are the evidence.

## NOTES / OBSERVATIONS ·

Students often surprise themselves by enjoying genres they thought they'd hate.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

What changed from the original

**CHANGES**

Teacher

This kit is built from three of my documents: the **Project Sheet & Rubric**, the **Teacher Notes** and the **Genre Exploration** entry on my DMP2 project menu. This page lists every change to my wording, so you know exactly what is mine and what was added.

## WORDING CHANGES ·

- My LMS name is written as “your class page” (checklist items 2, 3 and 5, and in the Genre Research Google Form resource).
- Page numbers are added to steps 1 to 4 and step 6 (the Genre research sheet, Reference track log, Loop and form sketch, Work plan and Reflection page).
- My Genre Research Google Form is yours and is not included. The kit adds a paper Genre research sheet beside it as a planning copy (page 12); requirement 2 is unchanged.
- My resources about streaming services and a shared class playlist are listed as I wrote them. No track, link or playlist is included.
- My Easier variation (a curated list of 5–8 genres with starter reference tracks and cheat sheets) is laid out as a blank Genre shortlist for you to fill in (page 10). The kit names no genre, because my sheets name none.
- My pacing guide’s “Classes 3–5” row spans the Class 3, 4 and 5 rows, so each class can name its slides.
- Layout only: the rubric’s Name and Date lines moved to the top; its Notes box became ruled lines.
- **Reflection page, not a new task (page 22).** My sheet already asks for a written reflection (requirement 6, step 6, checklist), so this kit adds no extra task. It adds prompts only, because my fourth struggle says to give specific prompts, and follows my definition (a written or oral conversation about how the student did and what they would do differently), so you may take it orally. No points, no rubric row.
- The intro deck shortens my wording (full wording on pages 16–18): slide 3 shortens my overview and a goal, slide 6 shortens my four vocabulary definitions, slides 7 and 10 shorten steps 1 and 2, slide 9 shortens requirements 4 and 5, my third struggle and tip 1, slide 11 shortens steps 3 and 4, slide 13 shortens tips 2 to 4, slide 14 shortens step 5 and the Harder variation, slide 15 shortens steps 5 to 7, slide 16 shortens the submission checklist, and slide 18 shortens step 7.

## KEPT AS I WROTE IT ·

Everything else from my three documents is kept as I wrote it: the overview, goals, vocabulary, six requirements, steps (apart from the page numbers), tips, checklist and file name (“Your Name – Genre Exploration”), the /25 rubric, what the project reinforces, the four struggles, the variations, my three resources, my pacing and my closing note, and the project menu entry on page 3. No rubric row is added and the requirements are unchanged.

## NEW IN THIS KIT ·

Everything else is new and supports my sheets without changing them: the how-to, overview and setup pages, the teacher moves in the pacing guide, the grading suggestions, the Logic quick reference, the Genre shortlist (my Easier variation as a blank, my Harder variation laid out), the worked example (an invented genre, three invented reference tracks and a 2:36 arrangement, on paper, not audio), the research sheet, reference log, loop sketch and Work plan, the vocabulary and presentation pages, the Reflection prompts and the intro deck. None adds a requirement or a rubric row.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Logic quick reference

**SETUP**

Teacher + student

Where to find the tools a Genre Exploration project is likely to use. Demonstrate what your class needs on Classes 1 and 3 and then let students work. Names are from current Logic Pro versions; check the labels on yours.

| | |
|---|---|
| **New project and tracks** | File › New…, then add tracks with Track › New Tracks…: a Software Instrument track for MIDI sounds, an Audio track for recordings, a drum track for beats. |
| **Set the tempo** | Click the tempo in the control bar and type the BPM you measured from your references. Tap Tempo (the tempo display's menu) helps if you are not sure. |
| **Bring in a reference** | Drag an audio file you own or have the right to use onto its own Audio track, name it "REF" and mute it when you are not comparing. Delete it before you bounce. Only your own track is handed in. |
| **Loop and arrangement** | Build the 8–16 bar loop, then copy and paste regions to build sections. Name and color each section so the form is easy to see. |
| **Software instruments** | Open the Library (Y) to browse sounds by category and try instruments until the sound fits the genre. Drum Kit Designer and Drum Machine Designer give genre-specific drum kits. |
| **Mixer: volume and panning** | Press X to open the Mixer. Move each track's fader for volume and its Pan knob to place it. |
| **EQ and filters** | Add Channel EQ to a channel strip. A high-cut or low-cut filter changes how bright or heavy a part sounds; cut what you do not need before you boost anything. |
| **Reverb and effects** | Insert Space Designer or ChromaVerb to give a part space; Delay and Compressor are also on the channel strip. Keep effects subtle until the rest of the mix is balanced. |
| **Automation** | Press A to show automation, choose a parameter such as volume or a filter, and draw changes over time. |
| **Save versions** | Use File › Save As… with a numbered name before each big change. |
| **Bounce and zip** | File › Bounce › Project or Section (Command-B), MP3 or WAV. In Finder, Control-click the .logicx and choose Compress. |

### VERSION NOTE

Menu names are from current Logic Pro versions; older versions may differ slightly. Logic Pro is a trademark of Apple Inc., named only to describe what the project needs. This resource is not affiliated with Apple.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Genre shortlist and my Harder variation

**TEACHER**

Easier + Harder

My Easier variation: provide a curated list of 5–8 genres with starter reference tracks and cheat sheets. This page is a **blank for you to fill in**: this kit names no genre, artist or song, because my sheets name none. Choose genres your students are unlikely to make already (my first struggle). Fill in 5–8 rows.

## GENRE SHORTLIST (KIT TEMPLATE) ·

| GENRE | STARTER REFERENCE TRACKS (TITLE AND ARTIST) | CHEAT SHEET IN A LINE (TEMPO, RHYTHM, SOUND, FORM, PRODUCTION) |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

### A ONE-GENRE CHEAT SHEET HAS FIVE LINES

- **Tempo:** a range in beats per minute
- **Rhythm:** the drum pattern and groove
- **Sound:** instruments, synths and samples
- **Form:** the usual sections and lengths in bars
- **Production:** space, filters, loudness, what is quiet or bright

### MY HARDER VARIATION, LAID OUT

- **2+ minutes, full arrangement.** The worked example (page 11) is 2:36 in sections.
- **2 genre-specific mixing techniques.** Students write them on the Work plan (page 15); the worked example shows two.

### HOW TO USE THIS PAGE

Write the list on the board or share it on your class page on Class 1, with starter tracks you have chosen. Genre Exploration stays open: a student may pick a genre off the list if you approve it. The list and the tracks are yours; nothing here is audio, and the kit does not suggest any.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Worked example · an invented genre

**EXAMPLE**

Teacher

An **invented genre, "Harbor Drift", with three invented reference tracks, described on paper**: no audio is included and no real genre is named. Students' projects will differ.

## 1 · A GENRE CARD ·

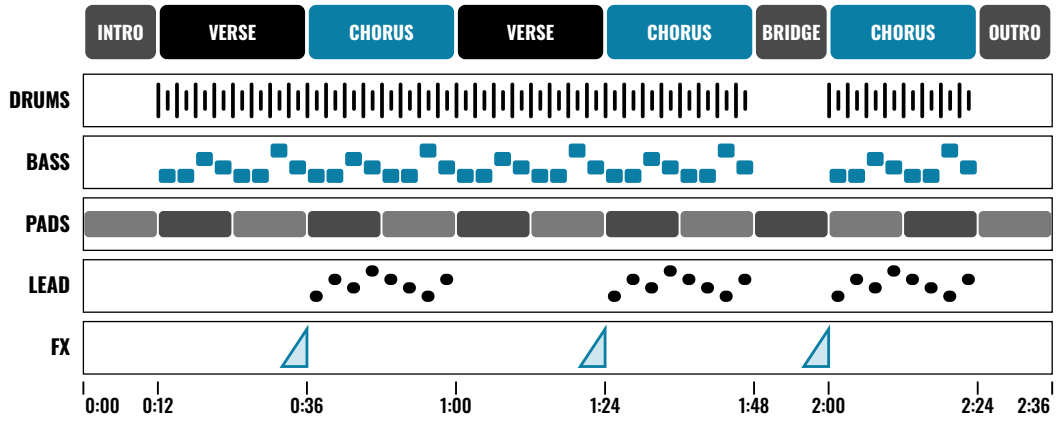
| | |
|---|---|
| **Tempo** | about 76–84 beats per minute |
| **Rhythm** | soft kick on beats 1 and 3, light brushed hi-hat in eighth notes, no heavy snare |
| **Instruments and sounds** | wide warm pads, a plucked bass, a bell-like lead; no distorted guitars |
| **Song form** | intro, verse, chorus, verse, chorus, a short bridge, chorus, outro |
| **Production style** | lots of space: reverb on the pads, the drums' highs rolled off, the bass quiet and centered |

## 2 · THREE REFERENCE TRACKS, BROKEN DOWN ·

| TRACK | TEMPO | FORM | NOTES |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Reference A** | about 80 BPM | 4 + 8 + 8 + 8 + 8 + 4 = 40 bars | starts with the pads alone |
| **Reference B** | about 84 BPM | 4 + 8 + 8 + 8 + 8 + 8 + 4 = 48 bars | drums wait until the first verse |
| **Reference C** | about 76 BPM | 4 + 8 + 8 + 4 + 8 + 8 + 4 = 44 bars | a short bridge before the last chorus |

What they share: slow, spacious, the same section order, a short intro and a short bridge.

## 3 · THE ARRANGEMENT MAP: 2:36 ·




### 4 · CHECKING THE NUMBERS

80 beats per minute is 0.75 s a beat, so a bar of 4/4 is 3 s. Sections: 4 + 8 + 8 + 8 + 8 + 4 + 8 + 4 = 52 bars, and 52 × 3 s = 156 s = 2:36. It follows the form the three references share, and each chorus brings back the lead.

### 5 · INSTRUMENTS RIGHT, PRODUCTION WRONG?

**Weak:** I used pads, a bass and a bell. It is Harbor Drift.

**Strong:** The instruments are only half of Harbor Drift. The drums' highs are rolled off so they stay soft, the pads sit in a wide reverb while the bass stays dry and in the center, and the whole track is quiet and spacious like Reference A, B and C. I checked this by playing Reference A next to my track in Logic and matching the space.

### 6 · TWO GENRE-SPECIFIC MIXING TECHNIQUES (MY HARDER VARIATION)

| | |
|---|---|
| **Roll off the drums' highs** | A gentle low-pass filter on the drums keeps the hi-hat soft, as in all three references. |
| **Wide reverb on the pads only** | A long reverb on the pads gives the space; the bass stays dry and centered so it is not washed out. |

**Three Padlet questions (invented):** 1. Where did you first hear the track open up? 2. Which part would you turn up or down, and why? 3. Does it sound like the genre I described?

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Genre research sheet

**STUDENT**

Classes 1–2

Name _____ Date _____

Step 1: select your genre and complete the Google Form analyzing its key characteristics. This sheet is a **paper planning copy** for the same job. Your teacher's Google Form is separate, and you still complete it before composing.

**My genre:** _____

**What I usually make:** _____

**GENRE CHECK (REQUIREMENT 1)**

- ☐ This genre is NOT one I am already comfortable producing in.
- ☐ My teacher has seen my genre.

| WHAT DEFINES IT | WHAT I FOUND (BE SPECIFIC) | WHERE I HEARD IT (REFERENCE A, B OR C) |
|---|---|---|
| **Tempo** range in BPM | | |
| **Rhythm** drum pattern, groove, feel | | |
| **Instruments and sounds** what plays, what is missing | | |
| **Song form** sections and how long each lasts | | |
| **Production style** space, filters, loudness, bright or dark | | |

**The sound I would miss most if it were gone:** _____

**What I think will be hardest to copy:** _____

**My Google Form is done:** _____ **Date:** _____

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Reference track log

STUDENT

Classes 1–2

Name _____ Date _____

Step 2: study 2–3 reference tracks and break down their elements. A reference track is a professionally produced song you study and use as a guide. Pick your own tracks and write what you hear. Reference C is optional.

| WHAT I NOTICE | REFERENCE A | REFERENCE B | REFERENCE C |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Title and artist** | | | |
| **Tempo (BPM) and feel** | | | |
| **Sections, each in bars** | | | |
| **Instruments and sounds I hear** | | | |
| **Production: space, filters, loudness** | | | |
| **One thing I will borrow** | | | |

## WHAT MY REFERENCES SHARE

**Tempo range:** _____

**Form (sections in order):** _____

**The sounds in all of them:** _____

**What is true of the production in all of them:** _____

## COMPARE IN LOGIC (MY SECOND TIP)

- ☐ I put a reference on its own track in Logic and compared it with my mix.
- ☐ I deleted the reference track before I bounced.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Loop and form sketch

**STUDENT**

Classes 2–3

Name _____ Date _____

Step 3: build an 8–16 bar loop that captures the genre's essence. Mark which layers play in which bars. Step 4: develop the full song structure and follow the typical song form of your genre.

## THE LOOP: ONE BOX PER BAR ·

| LAYER | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 | 6 | 7 | 8 | 9 | 10 | 11 | 12 | 13 | 14 | 15 | 16 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Drums** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Bass** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Chords / pads** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| **Lead** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |
| **FX / other** | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | | |

**Tempo (BPM):** _____ **Why this loop sounds like my genre:** _____

## THE FULL SONG FORM ·

| | | | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Section:<br>Bars: | Section:<br>Bars: | Section:<br>Bars: | Section:<br>Bars: | Section:<br>Bars: | Section:<br>Bars: | Section:<br>Bars: | Section:<br>Bars: |

### HOW LONG WILL IT BE?

A bar of 4/4 lasts 240 ÷ BPM seconds. My Harder variation asks for 2+ minutes.

**Total bars** _____ **× seconds per bar** _____ **= seconds** _____ **= minutes** _____

**My form matches the references because:** _____

## NOTES TO MYSELF ·

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Work plan

**STUDENT**

Classes 3–5

Name _____ Date _____

Steps 4 and 5: develop the full song structure, layer instrumentation and refine, then apply genre-appropriate mixing. Before each class write what you plan to finish; after it, what you actually did.

| CLASS | FIXED BY THE SCHEDULE | WHAT I PLAN TO FINISH | WHAT I ACTUALLY FINISHED |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Class 1** | Genre selected; Google Form begun | | |
| **Class 2** | Research done; loop started | | |
| **Class 3** | | | |
| **Class 4** | | | |
| **Class 5** | | | |
| **Class 6** | Final mix, bounce, reflection | | |
| **Class 7** | Present; answer 2 questions | | |

## INSTRUMENTS ARE NOT ENOUGH: PRODUCTION CHECK

**Instruments and sounds I used that belong to the genre:** _____

**How my references are mixed (space, filters, loudness):** _____

**Where my mix is different from them:** _____

## TWO GENRE-SPECIFIC MIXING TECHNIQUES (MY HARDER VARIATION)

1. _____
2. _____

**I will start my final mix in Class** _____ **because** _____

**The part of my track I am proudest of so far:** _____

**The part that is not working yet:** _____

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Name _____ Date _____

# GENRE EXPLORATION

Digital Music Production | *Structured Project* | 7 class periods

## OVERVIEW ·

Step outside your comfort zone. Pick a musical genre you're unfamiliar with, research what defines it, and produce a track that captures its signature sound. This project pushes you to listen deeper, experiment with new sounds, and grow as a producer.

## GOALS ·

- Research and identify the defining characteristics of an unfamiliar genre
- Compose a track that authentically reflects the genre's conventions
- Apply genre-appropriate instrumentation, production techniques, and mixing
- Reflect on the creative process and what you learned

## KEY VOCABULARY ·

| | |
|---|---|
| **Genre** | A category of music defined by shared characteristics like rhythm, instrumentation, and structure |
| **Reference Track** | A professionally produced song you study and use as a guide for your own production |
| **Instrumentation** | The specific instruments and sounds used in a piece of music |
| **Song Form** | How a song is structured — verse, chorus, bridge, etc. |

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

STUDENT

Project sheet · requirements and steps



Name _____ Date _____

## REQUIREMENTS ·

- ☐ Choose a genre you are NOT already comfortable producing in
- ☐ Complete the Genre Research Google Form before composing
- ☐ Your track should follow typical song forms and conventions of the genre
- ☐ Use instruments, synths, or samples authentic to the genre
- ☐ Apply genre-appropriate mixing and production techniques
- ☐ Write a short reflection (1 paragraph minimum) on what you learned

## STEPS / PROCESS ·

1. **Research** — Select your genre and complete the Google Form analyzing its key characteristics (Genre research sheet: page 12)
2. **Listen** — Study 2–3 reference tracks and break down their elements (Reference track log: page 13)
3. **Sketch** — Build an 8–16 bar loop that captures the genre's essence (Loop and form sketch: page 14)
4. **Compose** — Develop the full song structure. Layer instrumentation and refine. (Work plan: page 15)
5. **Mix** — Apply genre-appropriate mixing techniques. Polish the track.
6. Write your reflection and finalize your bounce (Reflection: page 22)
7. **Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

STUDENT

Project sheet · tips and checklist



Name _____ Date _____

## TIPS FOR SUCCESS ·

- Commit to the genre fully. Don't just add one instrument that "sounds kinda like it."
- Use reference tracks constantly. Pull them into Logic and compare your mix.
- Don't be afraid to sound weird to yourself — that's the point.
- Your Google Form research will save you time later.

## SUBMISSION CHECKLIST ·

- ☐ Genre Research Google Form completed
- ☐ Bounced .mp3 or .wav uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Zipped .logicx project file uploaded to your class page
- ☐ Files named correctly: "Your Name – Genre Exploration"
- ☐ Written reflection submitted via your class page
- ☐ Padlet post created with your 3 feedback questions
- ☐ Answered at least 2 questions on classmates' Padlet posts during presentations

## NOTES ·

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

RUBRIC

Rubric

/ 25

Name _____ Date _____

## GRADING RUBRIC /25

Genre Exploration | Structured Project

Each category is scored 1–5. Your final grade is the average of your self-score and your teacher's score.

| Category | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **CREATIVITY & ORIGINALITY** | Minimal creative effort; relies on defaults or clichés | Some creative ideas but largely predictable | Shows originality; experiments with sound or style | Highly creative; unique approach with clear artistic intent | Exceptional creativity; innovative, bold, and expressive |
| **TECHNICAL SKILL / DAW USE** | Limited understanding of Logic Pro tools | Basic tool use with frequent errors | Competent workflow; uses tools correctly | Advanced use of Logic features and shortcuts | Expert-level command of multiple Logic systems |
| **COMPOSITION & STRUCTURE** | Disorganized; no clear form or direction | Some structure present but underdeveloped | Clear, cohesive form with logical sections | Engaging structure with dynamic progression | Professional pacing, flow, and musical arc |
| **SOUND DESIGN & MIX QUALITY** | Poor sound choices; unbalanced or muddy mix | Some variety but inconsistent levels and EQ | Good sound selection; mostly balanced mix | Strong sound palette; clean, well-balanced mix | Exceptional sound design; professional-quality mix |
| **DOCUMENTATION & PRESENTATION** | Missing or incomplete; no reflection | Minimal documentation with little insight | Satisfactory; provides basic detail and reflection | Well-documented; clear and thoughtful reflection | Exceptional; thorough insight and polished delivery |

| | |
|---|---|
| Student Score: _____ / 25 | Teacher Score: _____ / 25 |
| **Final Grade = Average of Student + Teacher = _____ / 25** | |

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Key vocabulary

STUDENT

Vocabulary

Name _____ Date _____

The four words from your project sheet, with my definitions. Rewrite each in your own words, then show where it happens in your own project.

**GENRE** — A category of music defined by shared characteristics like rhythm, instrumentation, and structure

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my genre:** _____

**REFERENCE TRACK** — A professionally produced song you study and use as a guide for your own production

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my genre:** _____

**INSTRUMENTATION** — The specific instruments and sounds used in a piece of music

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my genre:** _____

**SONG FORM** — How a song is structured — verse, chorus, bridge, etc.

**In my own words:** _____

**Where it shows up in my genre:** _____

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Present and get feedback

**STUDENT**

Classes 6–7

Name _____ Date _____

**FROM YOUR PROJECT SHEET, STEP 7**

**Present & Get Feedback** — Create your own Padlet post with 3 questions you want classmates to answer about your project. Present to the class. During classmates' presentations, answer at least 2 of their 3 questions on their Padlet post.

## MY THREE FEEDBACK QUESTIONS ·

Ask about things you really want to know, not yes-or-no questions.

**Question 1:** _____

**Question 2:** _____

**Question 3:** _____

## CLASSMATES' QUESTIONS I ANSWERED (AT LEAST 2) ·

| CLASSMATE | THEIR QUESTION | MY ANSWER |
|---|---|---|
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |
| | | |

## BEFORE I PRESENT ·

- ☐ Files named "Your Name – Genre Exploration"; the Google Form, reflection, .mp3 or .wav and zipped .logicx submitted
- ☐ Padlet post created with my 3 questions
- ☐ Rubric self-score done (page 19)

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# GENRE EXPLORATION

Reflection · what did you learn?

**STUDENT**

Class 6

Name _____ Date _____

### WHAT THIS PAGE IS

My sheet asks for a short written reflection, 1 paragraph minimum, on what you learned. A reflection is a written or oral conversation about how you did on the project and what you would do differently next time. Answer the prompts below, then write your paragraph on your class page. Your teacher may take it orally instead.

### THIN (AN INVENTED EXAMPLE)

I learned a lot. It was fun and I liked the genre more than I thought.

### USEFUL (AN INVENTED EXAMPLE)

I thought I would hate slow, spacious music, but I liked it. The hard part was the mix: my first bounce had every part loud and dry, so it sounded like a different genre even with the right instruments. Comparing to Reference A showed me the drums needed their highs rolled off. Next time I would start with the pads and the space first, and I would check my references in the first class instead of the fourth. My strongest rubric category is Composition and Structure; my weakest is Mix.

**1** **What went well?** Name something in your project you are proud of, and say why it worked.

**2** **What did you struggle with?** Say what was hard and what you tried to fix it.

**3** **What would you do differently next time?** Be specific: a step, a choice, a sound or a tool.

**4** **Look at the rubric (page 19).** Which category are you proudest of, and which would you work on first next time?

**5** **What did you learn about the genre?** Say what surprised you, and whether your opinion of it changed.

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## QUESTIONS?

Please use the Q&A tab on the Hudson Beat by Brian Lotze store on Teachers Pay Teachers. If something looks wrong, let me know there and I will fix it.

## CREDITS

- Project sheet, rubric, teacher notes and intro deck: original work by Brian Lotze, Hudson Beat.
- Worked example (an invented genre, three invented reference tracks and an arrangement described on paper), the vinyl, step, genre-fingerprint and arrangement-map drawings and layouts: original work, Hudson Beat.
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